

Diversity of lawmakers higher, yet gaps remain

After redistricting, ratio improves but Beacon Hill still dominated by whites

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

When Massachusetts lawmakers last reshaped the state’s electoral map, Democratic leaders carved out the lines with a specific intention: to open more doors for candidates of color to join a mostly white Legislature.

More than four years later, the state Legislature has never had more lawmakers of color. It’s also still far from reflecting the diversifying population it represents — and some fear that at this pace, it may take decades to get there.

“We don’t have 30 years,” said state Senator Liz Miranda, a Roxbury Democrat and one of two women of color in the state Senate. “Not in a state that I think is progressive and I think is the model for democracy of this country. And if it’s not happening here, where else is it happening?”

The next chance to accelerate that change comes this year, with every legislative seat on the ballot in November. Candidates of color have made huge strides since redistricting in 2021,

LAWMAKERS, Page A10

Prominent art patron killed as he walked dog

Hit-and-run driver held on murder, other charges

By Camilo Fonseca and Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

John Axelrod, a major philanthropist and benefactor to the Museum of Fine Arts, was struck and killed by a hit-and-run driver Saturday morning while walking his dog in his Back Bay neighborhood, Boston police said.

The driver, identified as William Haney, 42, of Boston, has been charged with one count of murder and animal cruelty. Axelrod’s dog, Tale, was killed in the crash, authorities said. Haney is due to be arraigned Monday in the Central Division of Boston Municipal Court, prosecutors said.



John Axelrod

Axelrod’s death stunned Boston’s philanthropic and cultural communities, where for decades he was known as a reliable and prolific benefactor.

Axelrod, 79, was “a generous supporter and passionate advocate for underrepresented artists,” who had been part of the MFA community since the 1980s, the museum said in a statement.

The John Axelrod Collection at the MFA contains nearly 70 works by Black artists, the statement said.

The crash occurred on a cold morning, when

PEDESTRIAN, Page A5

A SIGN OF PATS’ TIME



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots quarterback Drake Maye did a bit of everything Sunday, including a little refereeing on this rushing touchdown by Rhamondre Stevenson in New England’s 38-10 win over the Miami Dolphins. **C1.**

Trump, Rubio offer next steps after US attack in Venezuela

Plans to control Caracas unclear; Maduro deputy offers placating note

By Edward Wong
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump asserted again Sunday night that the United States was “in charge” of Venezuela, hours after his top diplomat had pivoted away from such earlier suggestions of direct control to say that the administration would instead coerce cooperation from the new leadership in Caracas.

“We’re dealing with the people that just got sworn in,” Trump told reporters as he

flew back to Washington from Florida. “And don’t ask me who’s in charge, because I’ll give you an answer, and it’ll be very controversial.”

“What does that mean?” a reporter asked.

“It means we’re in charge,” the president said.

Trump did not provide details, but he appeared to be referring to control over the Venezuelan government, whose top officials had made defiant statements after the US mili-

VENEZUELA, Page A7

GOP divides

The intervention complicates Trump’s bid to hold together the party’s coalition, with mid-terms on horizon. **A6.**

A call for patience

Local Venezuelans expressed a range of emotions. **B1.**

Through Rodriguez, administration hopes to create a conduit to success

By Anatoly Kurmanaev, Tyler Pager, and Simon Romero
NEW YORK TIMES

It was one dance move too many for Venezuela’s President Nicolás Maduro.

Maduro in late December rejected an ultimatum from President Trump to leave office and go into a gilded exile in Turkey, according to several Americans and Venezuelans involved in transition talks.

Last week he was back on-stage, brushing off the latest US

escalation — a strike on a dock that the United States said was used for drug trafficking — by bouncing to an electronic beat on state television while his recorded voice repeated in English, “No crazy war.”

Maduro’s regular public dancing and other displays of nonchalance in recent weeks helped persuade some on the Trump team that the Venezuelan president was mocking them and trying to call what he believed to be a bluff, accord-

NEW LEADER, Page A7

‘It’s really hard to lose something that you thought was yours.’

JOYCE MICHAUD, (below) on her house being taken by eminent domain



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

For these homeowners, new Cape bridge exacts own cost

Some have their houses taken by state; others face prospect of years of havoc, construction

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

Joyce Michaud never envisioned having to surrender her Cape Cod home and the views it offered of the Sagamore Bridge. But in about a week, she’ll have to.

Down the street, Dave Collins won’t have to give up his house — but wonders if it would be better if he did.

Massachusetts’ \$2.1 billion plan to replace the Sagamore Bridge is carving a literal path through Michaud’s and Collins’s Bourne neighborhood, putting its longtime residents into an onerous situation — regardless of whether they stay or go.

Michaud and a dozen other homeowners

BRIDGES, Page A10



“I’m going to die here watching them build that bridge in my front yard, and there’s not a thing I can do about it,” said Dave Collins.

Flake news

Monday: Light snow, chilly. High 24-29, low 23-28.

Tuesday: Warmer, rain late. High 33-38, low 31-36

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **B6.**

In 2025, Boston planners approved the smallest amount of new development in the past decade. **D1.**

Saving a bit of history, a rare and forgotten printing press has been extracted from its basement home at Franklin Cummings Tech and moved to the Museum of Printing in Haver-

hill. **B1.**

The slow process of trying to identify the victims of the Swiss resort fire has been prolonging the agony for families. **A3.**

The Secret Service has embarked on a campaign to boost recruitment. **A2.**

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